

# Day 5 — Mapping Customer Journeys to Product Features

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**Activity packet for participant quads.** Today's job: convert the week's strategy work into a **customer journey map** with three prioritized feature concepts that feed directly into Monday's Week-3 PRD drafting.

## Where we are in the week

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Days 1–4 produced: a Tier Sheet, a defensible North Star, three design principles, and an AI-assembled Strategy Brief. Today the quads bring those artifacts together by **mapping the actual user journey** through their problem and proposing the features that would most reduce friction.

Friday afternoon is the **Week-2 readout** — each quad presents an integrated strategy package that previews their Week-3 mini-capstone PRD.

## Inputs

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- The quad's **NS Defense Card** (Day 2)
  - The quad's **3 design principles** (Day 3)
  - The quad's **Strategy Brief** (Day 4) — especially the 5 pain themes
  - The quad's **Tier Sheet** (Day 1, refreshed Day 2)
  - The **Journey Map Canvas** (handout, A2 size)
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## What a customer journey map *is* and *is not*

| Is                                                                              | Is not                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| A timeline of user actions, thoughts, and emotions through a defined experience | A flowchart of your product's screens                         |
| Grounded in observed and reported behavior (Week 1 + Day 4)                     | An idealized version of how you wish people used your product |
| Specific to one persona doing one job                                           | A "general user" map                                          |
| A tool to find friction, then a tool to find leverage                           | An end-state that lives in a wiki and never updates           |

The TPM job is not to draw the prettiest map. It is to **find where the friction is highest** and connect those points to features that move the metrics.

## The Journey Map Canvas (today's main artifact)

A single A2 sheet with five horizontal swim lanes:

| Swim lane                        | Contents                                                                            |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Stage</b>                  | Phases of the journey (e.g., Pre-shift → On-shift → Mid-shift change → After-shift) |
| <b>2. Actions</b>                | What the user is <i>doing</i> (concrete verbs)                                      |
| <b>3. Thoughts</b>               | What they're thinking ("Did I close that ticket?")                                  |
| <b>4. Emotions</b>               | Curve from frustration to satisfaction (4-point scale)                              |
| <b>5. Touchpoints / friction</b> | Where product, paper, phone calls, and other systems intersect; star the friction   |

Below the swim lanes, two columns:

- **Top 5 friction points** (ranked by Week-1 pain severity)

- **Top 3 feature concepts** (each linked to a friction point and a metric it would move)
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## Activity 1 — Anchor the Journey

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**Format:** Quad • 35 min • Block 1

### Purpose

Draw the **factual** journey before debating fixes. Most quads jump to features prematurely — today's discipline is to map first.

### Setup

Each quad has its Day-3 persona, Day-4 Strategy Brief, and the Journey Map Canvas (A2 paper or large whiteboard). Stickies for stages.

### Steps

#### Quad protocol

1. **Pick one persona** (5 min). Almost certainly the dispatcher persona from Week 1 Day 3. Confirm.
2. **Pick one journey scope** (10 min). The quad chooses one of:
  - Pre-shift through end-of-shift (a single workday)
  - First-30-days experience (onboarding-heavy)
  - Mid-shift exception (a tech calls out sick — the canonical disruption)
3. **Stage the journey** (15 min). Sticky notes on the Canvas. 5–8 stages.
4. **Sanity-check against evidence** (5 min). Does each stage map to something in Week 1's interviews/tickets? If not, mark as inferred.

### Deliverable

A staged journey skeleton — actions and stages only. Thoughts/emotions/friction come next.

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## Activity 2 — Fill the Lanes

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**Format:** Quad • 40 min • Block 2

### Purpose

Populate Thoughts, Emotions, and Touchpoints lanes — and surface friction.

### Setup

Each quad has its staged journey from Activity 1 and the Week-1 interview transcripts within reach.

### Steps

#### Quad protocol

1. **Thoughts lane** (10 min). For each stage, write 1–2 quotes (real or composite) that capture what the user is thinking. Use language from the Week-1 interview transcripts where possible.
2. **Emotions lane** (10 min). Score each stage on a 4-point curve: 😊 → 😐 → 😞 → 😡 . Plot.
3. **Touchpoints lane** (15 min). For each stage, list every system or person the user interacts with: your product, paper, phone, other software, manager, customer. **Star the friction.**
4. **Walk-through review** (5 min). One quad member narrates the whole journey to the other two. Capture surprises.

#### What "good" looks like

- The emotions curve is **not flat**. A flat curve usually means the quad is sanitizing.
- Friction stars cluster at 2–3 stages, not 8. If everything is friction, nothing is.
- Touchpoints include **non-product** systems (paper, phone). Most journey maps under-represent these and miss the integration story.

#### Bridge to Week 4

The non-product touchpoints are the input to **Week 4's "system components" mapping**. Don't lose them.

## Deliverable

A populated Journey Map Canvas with stages, actions, thoughts (quotes), emotions curve, touchpoints (including non-product), and friction stars clustered at 2–3 stages.

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## Activity 3 — From Friction to Features

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**Format:** Quad • 40 min • Block 3

### Purpose

Translate the highest-friction stages into **3 feature concepts** that pass the strategy test.

### Setup

Each quad has its populated Journey Map (with friction stars), Tier Sheet, and 3 design principles visible.

### Steps

#### The strategy test for a feature concept

A feature concept earns a place on your map if it passes all three:

- ☐ **Friction link:** Names the specific stage and friction it would reduce
- ☐ **Metric link:** Names the operational signal or KPI it would move
- ☐ **Principle link:** Aligns with at least one of the quad's 3 design principles (or names which it deliberately trades off)

### Quad protocol

1. **Brainstorm 8 candidate features** (15 min). Volume first. No vetting.
2. **Apply the strategy test** (15 min). Three checkboxes per candidate. Most will fail one.
3. **Cull to 3** (10 min). The 3 that pass cleanest.

## The feature card template

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## Feature concept: <short name>

**Stage(s) addressed:** <journey stages>
**Friction reduced:** <specific friction starred on the map>
**Metric it moves:** <op-signal or KPI from your Tier Sheet>
**Aligned principle:** <which of the 3 from Day 3>
**Trade-off / risk:** <what we'd give up; what could go wrong>
**Validation:** how would we know it actually moved the metric in 30 days?
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### Deliverable

3 feature cards per quad, each linking a journey stage + friction + metric + principle + trade-off + validation approach.

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## Activity 4 — Friday Readouts (Full Week-2 Package)

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**Format:** Quad • 45 min total + readouts • Block 4

### Purpose

Each quad delivers a **12-minute integrated strategy package** to the cohort. Peer + instructor scoring.

### Setup

Each quad has all six Week-2 artifacts: NS Defense Card, Tier Sheet, 3 design principles, Strategy Brief, Journey Map, 3 feature cards.

### Steps

#### What to present (in order)

1. **North Star + counter-metric** (1 min)
2. **Tier Sheet causal chain** (2 min) — three sentences
3. **One design principle in detail** (2 min) — the one they expect most pushback on

4. **Journey map walk-through** (4 min) — narrate the persona's journey, friction stars
5. **3 feature concepts** (3 min) — each with stage, friction, metric, principle

### Scoring rubric (live, by peers + instructor)

| Dimension           | Weight | What "exemplary" looks like                                                 |
|---------------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Metric coherence    | 25%    | NS, KPIs, op-signals form a believable causal chain                         |
| North Star defense  | 20%    | Quad can name + rebut three pitfalls applied to their own NS                |
| Journey realism     | 20%    | Map references observed Week-1 pain points; non-product touchpoints present |
| Feature linkage     | 15%    | Each top feature ties to journey friction AND a Tier Sheet metric           |
| AI-use transparency | 10%    | Where AI summarized research, prompts and validation steps disclosed        |
| Design awareness    | 10%    | At least one UX principle named with trade-off acknowledged                 |

### Quad workflow before readouts

1. **Assemble the package** (15 min). One artifact set, ordered.
2. **Rehearse** (15 min). Time each section. Cut anything that doesn't serve.
3. **Decide who speaks** (5 min). All three voices on the readout, not one designated talker.
4. **Predict the toughest peer challenge** (10 min). Be ready for it.

### Readouts (timing)

- 12 min per quad
- 3 min Q&A per quad
- All scores tallied

## Deliverable

A 12-minute integrated readout per quad covering NS → Tier Sheet → one design principle → journey map → 3 feature concepts, with all three voices presenting.

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## End-of-week checkpoint

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Each quad leaves the week with:

- ✓ **Locked North Star** with counter-metric and three pitfall rebuttals
- ✓ **Refreshed Metrics Tier Sheet** with NS / KPIs / 6+ operational signals
- ✓ **Three design principles** with one decision each principle would force
- ✓ **AI-Assembled Strategy Brief** with provenance log
- ✓ **Customer journey map** for one persona, one scope
- ✓ **Three feature concepts** that pass friction + metric + principle test

Every artifact is an input to **Week 3's PRD drafting**. Quads should leave the room with all six in shareable form.